



INSTRUCTIONAL AREA

Customer Relations

RESTAURANT AND FOOD SERVICES MANAGEMENT SERIES EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21st Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 30 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 15 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge)."
- "You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event."
- "Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

21st CENTURY SKILLS

- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Demonstrate a customer-service mindset.
2. Interpret business policies to customers/clients.
3. Explain the importance of meeting and exceeding customer/guest expectations.
4. Anticipate unspoken customer needs.
5. Explain the role of customer service as a component of selling relationships.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of the customer relations manager at *FARM TO FORK BISTRO*, an upscale farm-to-table restaurant that emphasizes locally sourced, organic ingredients. The restaurant manager (judge) wants you to create a plan for handling an increasing number of customer complaints regarding meal customization.

FARM TO FORK BISTRO has gained a strong following for its focus on fresh, seasonal dishes, and the restaurant prides itself on accommodating dietary preferences and restrictions. However, as the restaurant becomes more popular, there has been a noticeable rise in complaints from guests regarding the difficulty of customizing their meals. Some guests feel that the options for substitutions and modifications are limited, while others express frustration that certain dietary requests are not easily met.

The restaurant manager (judge) wants you to develop a solution that makes the meal customization process smoother while still maintaining the restaurant's high standards for quality and service. Your plan should address:

- How to streamline the customization process without slowing down kitchen operations or compromising the quality of dishes.
- How the new meal customization process will be communicated to guests.
- How to handle specific dietary restrictions (e.g., gluten-free, vegan, nut allergies) while ensuring that all modifications are safe and feasible.
- Additional guest services you could offer to enhance the dining experience, such as personalized menu suggestions or increased menu transparency.

You will present your ideas to the restaurant manager (judge) in a role-play to take place in the restaurant manager's (judge's) office. The restaurant manager (judge) will begin the role-play by greeting you and asking for your ideas. After you've presented your ideas and answered the restaurant manager's (judge's) questions, the restaurant manager (judge) will conclude the role-play by thanking you for your work.

Potential Judge's Questions:

1. How have you included the restaurant staff's input into your decision-making?
2. What other guest services or experiences could you introduce to enhance customer satisfaction and loyalty, especially for guests with frequent dietary requests?

Did the participant team:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Demonstrate a customer-service mindset?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
2.	Interpret business policies to customers/clients?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
3.	Explain the importance of meeting and exceeding customer/guest expectations?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
4.	Anticipate unspoken customer needs?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
5.	Explain the role of customer service as a component of selling relationships?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	Unique– Demonstrates original thinking, fresh perspectives, and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	Practical– Actionable/viable in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	Effective– Achieves relevant outcomes.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAREER COMPETENCIES						
9.	Critical Thinking– Thinks critically to understand and solve problems.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	Communication– Communicates clearly, effectively, and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	Decision-making– Considers the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSION						
12.	Overall impression– The degree to which the presentation leaves a lasting impression.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
TOTAL SCORE						